



INGLÉS 1



Universidad Tecnológica Nacional
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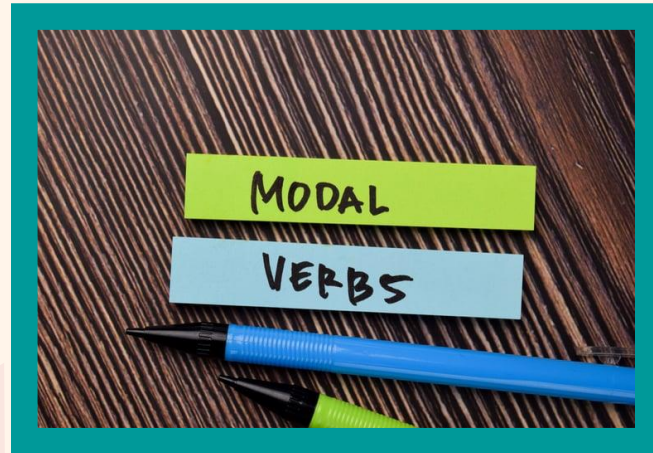
MODULE C

UNIT C5

Self-study Preview

Modal Verbs:

- ✓ <https://english.lingolia.com/es/gramatica/verbos/verbos-modales> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <http://original.ompersonal.com.ar/ELEMENTARY/unit19/page7.htm> (Sections: Grammar and Exercises x2).
- ✓ <https://www.mansioningles.com/Gram60.htm> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <https://www.mansioningles.com/Gram62.htm> (Sections: Grammar and Exercises x2).





➤ **Modal verbs** are a part of the larger category called “auxiliary verbs” which are verbs that cannot be used on their own. They need to be expressed by another (main) verb. The following are some of the modal verbs in English: Can, Could, May, Might, Must, Shall, Should, Will, Would, etc.

➤ Modal verbs provide **additional information** about the verb that follows it. They are used to express ability, obligation, permission, probability and possibility, requests and offers, advice, etc.



Each modal verb can have more than one meaning which depends on the context of that sentence (or question):

It **can** get cold there at night so take a jacket. (possibility / probability)

You **can** go now. (permission)

I **can** play the guitar. (ability)

Can I help you with the report? (offer)

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- They are mostly used in the present tense, if you need to use them in another tense you can use alternative forms. Anyway, they don't add an “-s” to the third person singular in the present tense.
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- They make questions by inversion ('She can sing.' becomes 'Can she sing?'), they just add “not” in the negative form, they do not use auxiliary verbs (do, does, did, etc.) because they are considered auxiliary verbs.
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- Most of them are followed directly by the infinitive of another verb (without 'to') with the exception of “have to”, “need to” and “ought to”.

MODAL	EXAMPLES	USES
CAN	He can find any street in London. You can take a taxi. Can you take me to Victoria Station?	<i>Ability</i> <i>Suggestion</i> <i>Request</i>
BE ABLE TO	He is able to find any street in London.	<i>Ability</i>
CAN'T	That story can't be true.	<i>Certainty that something is impossible</i>
COULD	I could play tennis when I was younger. Could you take me to Victoria Station? You could take a taxi.	<i>Ability</i> <i>Request</i> <i>Suggestion</i>
MAY	It may be quicker to travel by train. May I come in?	<i>Possibility</i> <i>Formal request/ Permission</i>
MIGHT	It might be quicker to travel by train.	<i>Possibility</i>
MUST	You must be back at 10 o'clock. Look at the snow. It must be cold outside.	<i>Obligation</i> <i>Certainty that something is true.</i>
HAVE TO	You have to be back at 10 o'clock.	<i>Obligation</i>
NEED TO	You need to study a lot.	<i>Obligation.</i>
NEEDN'T	You needn't have a university degree.	<i>Lack of obligation.</i>
MUSN'T	You mustn't drive without a license.	<i>Prohibition</i>
DON'T HAVE TO	You don't have to call a taxi.	<i>Lack of obligation</i>
SHOULD	You should drive more carefully.	<i>Opinion/Advice</i>
OUGHT TO	You ought to drive more carefully.	<i>Opinion/Advice</i>

Review of Verb Tenses



Simple Present

- Always, never, usually, often, hardly ever, etc.
- Once a week, every Monday, in June, twice a year, etc.

- ❑ Habits or situations that happen regularly:

I never **go** to the library. / She **works** in a hospital. / We **have lunch** at work.

- ❑ Present states or permanent situations:

I **don't drink** coffee. / He's very tall. / She **doesn't have** two brothers. / We **love** ice cream.

- ❑ Universal facts or truths, things that are always or generally true:

The sun **rises** in the east and **falls** in the west. / Water **is** tasteless, colorless and odorless.

- ❑ To talk about the scheduled future and in conditional sentences and future time clauses (after: if, when, as soon as, after, before, once, while):

The bus **leaves** at 7 tomorrow. / If it **doesn't rain** we'll go camping. / When he **is** 67, he will retire. / I'll call you as soon as I **arrive**.

Present Continuous

- Now, right now, at this moment, at present.
- These days, this week, this month, this year, today, Look!, Listen!

- ☐ Actions in progress, things that are happening now or “around now”:

I'm **watching** a new series now. / Listen! The neighbors **are having** an argument. / What **are you doing**?

- ☐ Temporary actions:

My car is in the garage; I **am taking** the bus to work. / I'm **not training** these days because I have an injury. / Teachers **are using** more and more technology to teach.

- ☐ Future arrangements (with a future time expression):

I'm **seeing** the dentist at 6. / We **are getting** married next week. / I'm **flying** to New York tomorrow morning.

Past Simple

- Yesterday, last night, last week, in 2022, one hour ago, ten years ago, always, usually, etc.

- ☐ Past finished actions:

We **arrived** last Friday. / I **missed** the train again. / We **moved** to Buenos Aires last year.
/ When **did** you **get** married?

- ☐ Actions in chronological order in a story:

I **opened** the door, **walked** into the room and **saw** him.

- ☐ Habitual actions in the past and past states:

Sarah always **arrived** on time. / She **traveled** very often. / He **didn't like** coffee. / She **was** very tall when she **was** a girl. / They **had** two children.

Future: Will

- In a minute, tomorrow, soon, then, next week, the following year, in 2050, in the future, etc.

- ☐ Predictions about something we think will happen:

I think he'll **win** the election. / He **will be** a good doctor. / I think it **will rain** later.

- ☐ Instant decisions:

I don't have sugar, I'll **ask** our neighbor. / Wait, I'll **have** a word with you.

- ☐ Promises:

I **will** always **love** you. / Don't worry. I **will pay** you back next week. / I'll **have** it ready in 5'.

- ☐ Offers:

I'll **carry** the bag for you. / I'll **help** you with the project. / **Shall I help** you with those bags?

Future: Be Going to

- In a minute, tomorrow, soon, then, next week, the following year, in 2050, in the future, etc.

- ☐ Predictions about something we see will happen (present evidence):

We don't know the answers, we **are going to fail** the test. / The doctor said **she is going to have** a baby girl. / Look at that girl! She's **going to fall down**.

- ☐ Decisions that you have already taken at the moment of speaking (intentions or plans):

I **am going to travel to** Egypt next month. / They **aren't going to go** to the cinema tonight. / He **is going to sing** at the wedding.



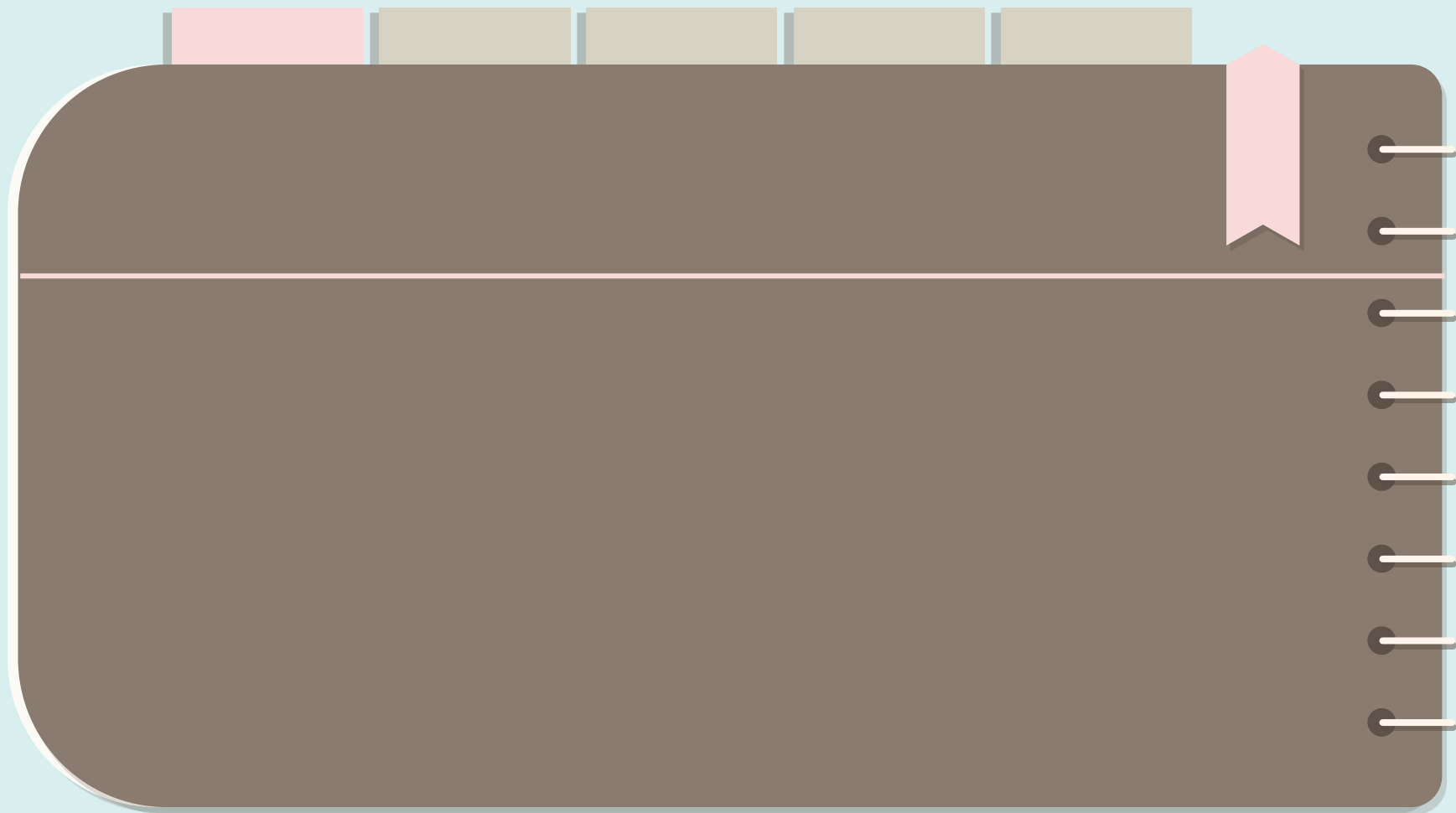
Modal Verbs:

- <https://www.esl-lounge.com/student/grammar/2g59-modals-multiple-choice.php> (Section: Exercises).
- <https://agendaweb.org/exercises/verbs/modals/mixed-1.htm> (Section: Exercises).
- <https://agendaweb.org/exercises/verbs/modals/mixed-2.htm> (Section: Exercises).
- <https://agendaweb.org/exercises/verbs/modals/mixed-3.htm> (Section: Exercises).



Review of Verb Tenses:

- <https://www.liveworksheets.com/w/en/english-second-language-esl/444670> (Section: Exercises).
- <https://www.tolearnenglish.com/exercises/exercise-english-2/exercise-english-118563.php> (Section: Exercises).
- <http://www.esl-lounge.com/student/grammar/1g31-present-simple-continuous-past-letter-gap-fill.php> (Section: Exercises).





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